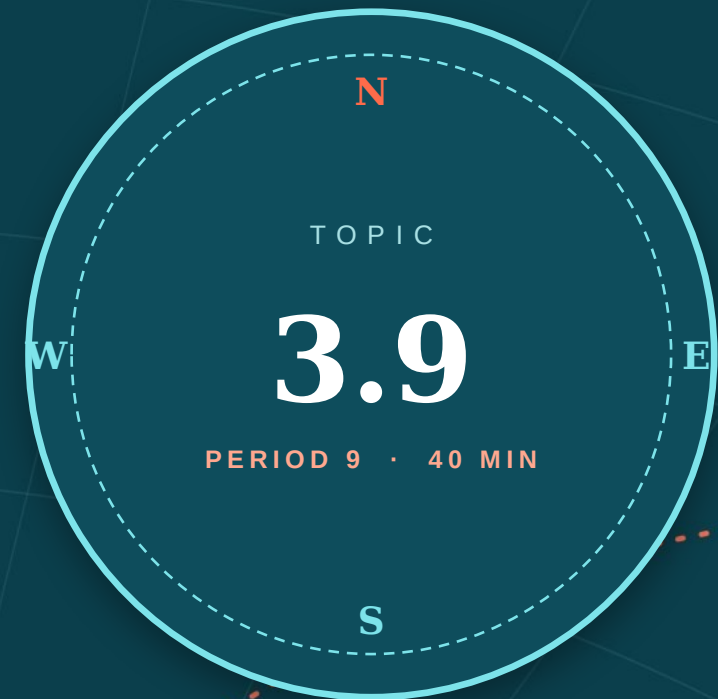


UNIT 3 · TOPIC 3.9

Seasonal and Day-of-Week Pricing

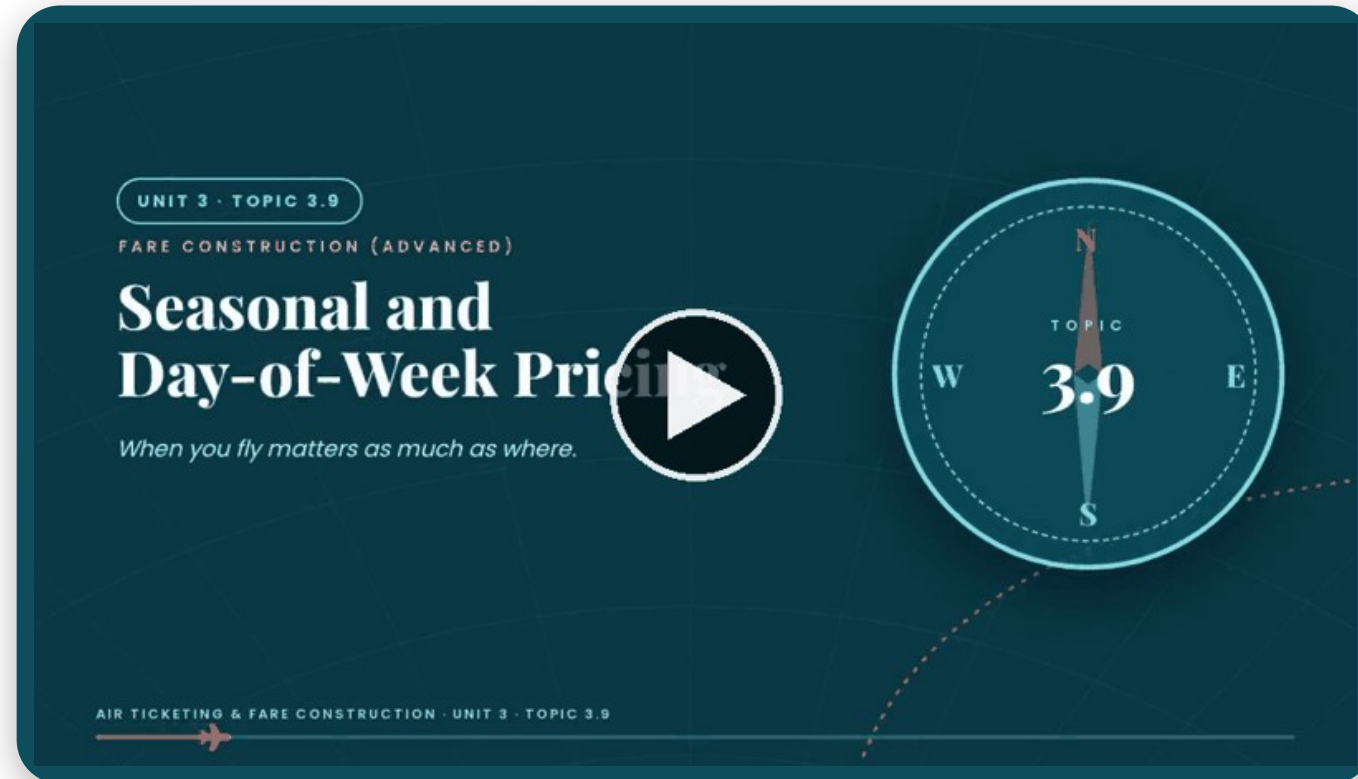
When you fly matters as much as where.

B.B.A. Aviation Management · Semester III · Unit 3: Fare Construction (Advanced)
Air Ticketing & Fare Construction (2ACBAM32) · Arun Kumar



TOPIC 3.9

Expedition Preview: Topic Intro



Air Ticketing & Fare Construction · Unit 3: Fare Construction (Advanced) · Topic 3.9

02

TOPIC 3.9

Navigator's Question



THINK ABOUT IT

Why does Friday cost more than Tuesday for exactly the same seat?

**THINK**

30 seconds alone

**PAIR**

1 minute with a neighbour

**SHARE**

2–3 answers with the class



TOPIC 3.9

Route Map for Today

1

3.9.1

Seasonal pricing: peak and off-peak fares

2

3.9.2

Day-of-week pricing: weekend vs weekday travel

3

3.9.3

Price variability

4

3.9.4

Role of demand forecasting in seasonal and day-of-week pricing



COURSE OBJECTIVES

- Explain seasonal fare structures
- Explain weekday/weekend pricing
- Measure price variability with online tools
- Link forecasting to pricing

Pedagogy: Technology-Based Learning

TOPIC 3.9.1

Seasons in Fare Construction



High (H)

Peak demand: holidays, festivals, summer. Highest fares.



Shoulder (K)

Between peaks. Medium fares.



Low (L)

Lean demand. Lowest fares, promotions.



TOPIC 3.9.1

Example: India-Europe Seasons (Typical)



TOPIC 3.9.2

Weekday vs Weekend Fares



Weekday (X)

- Tue–Thu usually cheapest
- Less leisure demand mid-week
- Business peaks Mon a.m. & Fri p.m.

vs



Weekend (W)

- Fri–Sun higher for leisure routes
- Family and short-break demand
- Coded W in many fare bases

TOPIC 3.9.2

Day Codes in Fare Bases

W and X appear in many fare basis codes.

- X = weekday fare.
- W = weekend fare.
- Definitions of “weekend” vary by airline and market.
- Check Cat 2 (day/time).



SAME ROUTE, DIFFERENT DAYS (illustrative)

TUE	MLXIN	INR 5,200
WED	MLXIN	INR 5,200
FRI	MLWIN	INR 6,400
SUN	MLWIN	INR 6,400

// W adds INR 1,200 here

TOPIC 3.9.3

Price Variability (Illustrative)

DEL–BLR one-way economy, same airline, over one month.

₹4.2k

lowest (Tuesday, low demand)

₹6.1k

average

₹13.5k

highest (Friday before long weekend)



Tech task: use Google Flights date grid / price graph to see this live.

TOPIC 3.9.3

Tech Tools to Track Prices



Google Flights

Date grid, price graph, price tracking alerts.



Skyscanner / Kayak

“Whole month” and cheapest-day views.



OTA Fare Calendars

MakeMyTrip, ixigo low-fare calendars.



Airline Calendars

Lowest fare per day on airline sites.



TOPIC 3.9.4

Forecasting Drives Pricing

**History**

Past bookings by date and day

Events

Holidays, festivals, exams

Forecast

Predicted demand per flight

Set Buckets

Seats per fare class

Monitor

Adjust as bookings arrive

TOPIC 3.9.4

Forecasting in Practice

**Known peaks**

Diwali, summer holidays and long weekends are planned months ahead.

**Surprises**

Events, weather or news cause sudden demand changes.

**Machine learning**

Modern RM systems learn patterns automatically.

**FOR AGENTS**

Advise flexible travellers to shift a day or two — moving from Friday to Tuesday can save a large share of the fare.



TOPIC 3.9

Navigation Exercise: Price Graph Hunt



PEDAGOGY

Technology-Based Learning

TIME · 10 min

FORMAT · Pairs with devices

- 1 Open Google Flights (or an OTA calendar) for a route of your choice.
- 2 Record the cheapest and most expensive day over the next 2 months.
- 3 Label each as season/day-of-week effect or event.
- 4 Share: best day to fly and potential saving %.

TOPIC 3.9

[Click to reveal each answer](#)

Position Check Quiz

Q1**“L” in many fare bases indicates...**

- A) Low season
- B) Long haul
- C) Late booking
- D) Lounge

ANSWER

A**Q2****Usually the cheapest days to fly are...**

- A) Fri–Sun
- B) Tue–Wed
- C) Holidays
- D) Mondays

ANSWER

B**Q3****Seasonality rules are ATPCO Cat...**

- A) 3
- B) 8
- C) 16
- D) 31

ANSWER

A**Q4****Airlines set seats per fare bucket using...**

- A) Demand forecasting
- B) Weather only
- C) Crew rosters
- D) Seat maps

ANSWER

A

DESTINATION REACHED

Key Takeaways

- ✓ Seasons (H, K, L) shape fare levels
- ✓ Weekend (W) vs weekday (X) fares differ
- ✓ Online tools show big price variability
- ✓ Forecasting sets how many cheap seats exist

EXIT TICKET Write 1 thing you learned today + 1 question you still have.

NEXT WAYPOINT

Topic 3.10 — Understanding Fare Combinability

Thank you · Questions?

